

**CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL VALLEY REGION**

ORDER NO. 95-016

**WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
FOR
PLA-VADA COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
NEVADA COUNTY**

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region, (hereafter Board) finds that:

1. Pla-Vada Community Association (hereafter Discharger) submitted a Report of Waste Discharge and additional information, dated 29 October 1994, for their wastewater treatment and disposal facility. The property (Assessor's Parcel Number 47-010-29-000) is owned by Pla-Vada Community Association.
2. Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 86-024, adopted by the Board on 24 January 1986, prescribes requirements for a discharge from up to 352 homes to a package plant using a bridge-mounted aerator with discharge to four evaporation/percolation ponds and one overflow pond, as shown in Attachment A, which is attached hereto and part of the Order by reference.
3. Order No. 86-024 is neither adequate nor consistent with current plans and policies of the Board.
4. Wastewater is gathered from approximately 190 existing homes by gravity sewers and conveyed to pumps at the package wastewater treatment plant. Standby power is available to keep the plant and pumps operating during power outages. Wastewater will ultimately be generated from 352 homes in this subdivision if complete buildout occurs. In addition to the homes, the Kingvale Caltrans maintenance station discharges wastewater to the system.
5. Since the Pla-Vada subdivision is at an elevation of approximately 6,000 feet and many of the homes are vacation homes (there are approximately 24 homes occupied year-round), wastewater flow volumes vary considerably with the seasons. The maximum total wastewater flow is anticipated during the month of May and could equal 4.38 million gallons (an average of 141,300 gallons per day). Flows in August 1994 averaged about 24,000 gallons per day.
6. The package plant is rated to treat a design flow of 180,000 gallons per day. There is also an aerobic digester installed adjacent to the package plant. Because of the low flows to the package plant, it has not been necessary to use the digester to stabilize the sludge. The digester could be brought on line quickly if necessary.

**WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
PLA-VADA COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
NEVADA COUNTY**

-2-

7. The Pla-Vada subdivision is in Sections 19 and 20, T17N, R14E, MDB&M, with surface water drainage to the South Yuba River, as shown in Attachment B, which is attached hereto and part of the Order by reference.
8. The Board adopted a Water Quality Control Plan, Second Edition, for the Sacramento River Basin (hereafter Basin Plan), which contains water quality objectives for all waters of the Basin. These requirements implement the Basin Plan.
9. The beneficial uses of the South Yuba River are municipal, industrial, and agricultural supply; recreation; aesthetic enjoyment; navigation; ground water recharge; fresh water replenishment; hydropower generation; and preservation and enhancement of fish, wildlife, and other aquatic resources.
10. The beneficial uses of underlying ground water are domestic, industrial, and agricultural supply.
11. The Basin Plan encourages reclamation. The Discharger reviewed opportunities for reclamation and cannot reclaim effluent because there is no land suitable for irrigation due to the high elevation, short growing season, and poor soils.
12. The action to update waste discharge requirements for this facility is exempt from the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA), in accordance with Title 14, California Code of Regulations (CCR), Section 15308.
13. This discharge is exempt from the requirements of Title 23, CCR, Section 2510, et seq. (hereafter Chapter 15). The exemption, pursuant to Section 2511(b), is based on the following:
 - a. The Board is issuing waste discharge requirements, and
 - b. The discharge complies with the Basin Plan, and
 - c. The wastewater does not need to be managed according to 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 30, as a hazardous waste.
14. The Board has notified the Discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for this discharge and has provided them with an opportunity for a public hearing and an opportunity to submit their written views and recommendations.
15. The Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

**WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
PLA-VADA COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
NEVADA COUNTY**

-3-

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Order No. 86-024 is rescinded and Pla-Vada Community Association, its agents, successors, and assigns, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. Discharge Prohibitions:

1. Discharge of wastes to surface waters or surface water drainage courses is prohibited.
2. Bypass or overflow of untreated or partially treated waste is prohibited.
3. Discharge of waste classified as 'hazardous' or 'designated', as defined in Sections 2521(a) and 2522(a) of Chapter 15, is prohibited.

B. Discharge Specifications:

1. The monthly average dry weather discharge flow shall not exceed 180,000 gallons/day.
2. Objectionable odors originating at this facility shall not be perceivable beyond the limits of the wastewater treatment and disposal areas.
3. As a means of discerning compliance with Discharge Specification No. 2, the dissolved oxygen content in the upper zone (1 foot) of wastewater in ponds shall not be less than 1.0 mg/l.
4. Ponds shall not have a pH less than 6.5 or greater than 8.5.
5. Ponds shall be managed to prevent breeding of mosquitos. In particular,
 - a. An erosion control program should assure that small coves and irregularities are not created around the perimeter of the water surface.
 - b. Weeds shall be minimized through control of water depth, harvesting, or herbicides.
 - c. Dead algae, vegetation, and debris shall not accumulate on the water surface.
6. Public contact with wastewater shall be precluded through such means as fences, signs, control of access, or other acceptable alternatives.
7. Ponds shall have sufficient capacity to accommodate allowable wastewater flow and design seasonal precipitation and ancillary inflow and infiltration. Freeboard of the last pond in a

series shall never be less than two feet (measured vertically to the lowest point of overflow).

8. On or about 1 October of each year, available pond storage capacity shall at least equal the volume necessary to comply with Discharge Specification No. 7.

C. Sludge Disposal:

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of in a manner that is consistent with Chapter 15, Division 3, Title 23, of the California Code of Regulations and approved by the Executive Officer.
2. Any proposed change in sludge use or disposal practice from a previously approved practice shall be reported to the Executive Officer and U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) Regional Administrator at least 90 days in advance of the change.
3. Use and disposal of sewage shall comply with existing Federal and State laws and regulations, including permitting requirements and technical standards included in 40 CFR 503.

If the State Water Resources Control Board and the Regional Water Quality Control Boards are given the authority to implement regulations contained in 40 CFR 503, this Order may be reopened to incorporate appropriate time schedules and technical standards. The Discharger must comply with the standards and time schedules contained in 40 CFR 503 whether or not they have been incorporated into this Order.

4. If sludge is to be reused, for example as a soil amendment, the Discharger is encouraged to comply with the State Guidance Manual issued by the Department of Health Services titled *Manual of Good Practice for Landspreading of Sewage Sludge*.
5. By 1 July 1995, the Discharger shall submit a sludge disposal plan describing the annual volume of sludge generated by the plant and specifying the disposal practices.

D. Ground Water Limitations:

The discharge shall not cause underlying ground water to:

1. Be degraded.

**WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
PLA-VADA COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
NEVADA COUNTY**

-5-

2. Contain chemicals, heavy metals, or trace elements in concentrations that adversely affect beneficial uses or exceed maximum contaminant levels specified in 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 15.
3. Exceed a most probable number of total coliform organisms of 2.2/100 ml over any seven-day period.
4. Exceed concentrations of radionuclides specified in 22 CCR, Division 4, Chapter 15.
5. Contain taste or odor-producing substances in concentrations that cause nuisance or adversely affect beneficial uses.
6. Contain concentrations of chemical constituents in amounts that adversely affect agricultural use.

E. Provisions:

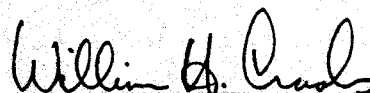
1. The Discharger shall comply with the Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 95-016, which is part of this Order, and any revisions thereto as ordered by the Executive Officer.
2. The Discharger shall comply with the "Standard Provisions and Reporting Requirements for Waste Discharge Requirements", dated 1 March 1991, which are attached hereto and by reference a part of this Order. This attachment and its individual paragraphs are commonly referenced as "Standard Provision(s)."
3. In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities described herein, the Discharger shall notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which shall be immediately forwarded to this office.
4. The Discharger shall use the best practicable cost-effective control technique currently available to comply with salinity limits specified in this order.
5. The Discharger must comply with all conditions of this Order, including timely submittal of technical and monitoring reports as directed by the Executive Officer. Violations may result in enforcement action, including Regional Board or court orders requiring corrective action or imposing civil monetary liability, or in revision or rescission of this Order.
6. A copy of this Order shall be kept at the discharge facility for reference by operating personnel. Key operating personnel shall be familiar with its contents.

**WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS
PLA-VADA COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION
NEVADA COUNTY**

-6-

7. If reclaimed water is used for construction purposes, it shall comply with the most current edition of "Guidelines for Use of Reclaimed Water for Construction Purposes". Other uses of reclaimed water not specifically authorized herein shall be subject to the approval of the Executive Officer and shall comply with 22 CCR, Division 4.
8. The Board will review this Order periodically and will revise requirements when necessary.

I, WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer, do hereby certify the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, Central Valley Region on 27 January 1995.



WILLIAM H. CROOKS, Executive Officer

JLE:dlk